

There are five known dwarf planets:
Ceres, Pluto, Makemake, Eris, and Haumea.

Asteroid 234 Ida

In between the orbits of Mars and Jupiter lies the asteroid belt. Asteroids are made up of a mixture of rock and ice. This space rubble is the detritus of planet formation.



Sun

The sun lies in the center of the solar system. It spins on its axis, taking less than 25 days to rotate despite its massive size.

Venus

Venus rotates in the opposite direction to the other planets, so slowly that it takes 224 days to complete one rotation.

Mercury

The closest planet to the sun, Mercury is also the smallest. It takes 88 days to make a trip around the sun, rotating three times for every two orbits.

Earth

Our home planet, Earth is the only planet we know of that can support life, thanks to its oceans and atmosphere.

Mars

Mars is a rocky planet, but it does not have a magnetic field like Earth's to deflect space radiation.

Orbit speed

The farther a planet is from the sun, the slower it travels and the longer its orbit takes. The most distant planet, Neptune, takes 165 years to travel around the sun, at 3.37 miles per second (5.43 km/s).

URANUS

Uranus is 1.78 billion miles (2.87 billion km) from the sun on average, or 19.14 AU.

NEPTUNE

Neptune orbits at 2.81 billion miles (4.53 billion km), an average of 30 times the distance between Earth and the sun, or 30 AU.